13 Write $x^2 + 6x - 7$ in the form $(x + a)^2 + b$ where a and b are integers.

×	x	3
x	x^2	$3x$
3	$3x$	9

$(x + 3)^2 = x^2 + 6x + 9$

1 mark

Half of 6 is 3: form the square

$x^2 + 6x - 7 = (x + 3)^2 - 9 - 7$

$= (x + 3)^2 - 16$

1 mark

Subtract 16 to keep the expression equal

$(x + 3)^2 - 16$

(Total for Question 13 is 2 marks)